

Example 5

```
<?php
function add($a,$b)
{
    $total = $a + $b;
    return $total;
}

$sum = add(5,8);

echo "5 + 8 = ".$sum;
?>
```

A function, “add”, is declared, with the parameters \$a and \$b, two variables that are being passed. The sum of these two variables is being passed to a variable \$sum, where the result of the addition is displayed.

4.6 Arrays

An array is a data structure capable of storing one or more than one value in a single value. PHP supports arrays as a data type as well. Arrays are very useful to store large numbers of similar variables.

An array is similar to a matrix; every element of an array has its own address, and can be referenced using that address. Arrays have great practical importance in any programming language, and particularly in PHP. Suppose a user wishes to load a list of clients from his database to use on his Web page; he/she would typically load it into an array. In all practical terms it would be highly inefficient to declare variables for each client, wouldn't it? Here's where array's come into the picture: not only is the code minimised, but efficiency in terms of storage and execution of scripting code can maintained.